

Borrower User Manual

One account, every lender — apply, track & repay your loans.

LenderFest • Borrower Guide • Generated 05/06/2026

A step-by-step guide for **borrowers** using the LenderFest customer portal to apply for and manage loans.

One account, every lender. With a single LenderFest login you can borrow from many lenders (microfinances, SACCOs, chamas, individuals), track all your loans in one place, and build a credit score that follows you across all of them.

1. Create your account

1. From the LenderFest home page, click **Create a free account** (or go to ``/portal/register``).
1. **Step 1 — Your details:** first & last name, phone number, national ID, email, date of birth, gender. You can also add your **business & location** (business name/type, county, town, address) — optional but recommended.
1. **Step 2 — Set a password:** at least 12 characters with an uppercase letter, a number, and a symbol.
1. **Step 3 — Verify your identity:** upload a **profile photo** and ****both sides** of your national ID**. Lenders use these to verify you. *(If document upload isn't available yet, you can add them later from your Profile.)*

Already added by a lender? If a lender created your account for you, just log in with your phone number and the password they gave you (usually your initials + ID number + `@<year>`, e.g. `Jd12345678@2026`) and change it. You'll be asked to upload your photo & ID the first time.

Log in

Go to ``/portal/login`` and enter your **phone number + password**. Forgot it? Use **Forgot password** on

the login screen.

2. Find a lender

Open **Lenders** (</lenders>) to browse every lender on LenderFest.

- Each lender shows a **type badge** — **Microfinance**, **SACCO**, **Chama**, or **Individual** — and is **colour-coded by type** so you can tell at a glance.
- **Filter** by lender **type**, by the **amount** you want, by ****maximum interest****, or search by name.
- Tap a lender to see its full terms (min/max amount, interest rate, duration).

Link to a lender

On a lender's page, **Link** your account (confirm with your password). Once linked, you can apply for loans with that lender. After you add your first lender, the list focuses on real lenders you can borrow from.

3. Estimate before you borrow

Open the **Calculator**:

- Choose **which lender** (drop-down of your linked lenders),
- enter the **amount** and **repayment period**,
- see your **monthly payment**, **total interest**, and **full schedule** before applying.

Then tap **Apply for this loan** to carry the figures into an application.

4. Apply for a loan

From a lender (or the calculator), **Apply**: confirm amount, duration, and **purpose** (e.g. business, school fees, emergency). Submit — the lender reviews it.

5. Track your applications

My Applications shows everything that hasn't been disbursed yet:

Status	What it means
Pending	Submitted, waiting for the lender

Under review	The lender is reviewing it
Approved	Approved — waiting for the lender to disburse the money
Counter-offered	The lender offered a different (smaller) amount — your action needed
Rejected	Declined

Respond to a counter-offer

If a lender **counter-offers** a smaller amount, open the application and choose:

- **Accept** □ the loan becomes **Approved** and waits for the lender to disburse.
- **Decline** □ the application is closed.

An **Approved** loan stays in *My Applications* until the lender **disburses** it. Once disbursed, it moves to **My Loans**.

6. My Loans

My Loans shows only loans that have been **disbursed** (money paid out):

Status	Meaning
Active	Disbursed and being repaid
Completed	Fully repaid
Defaulted	Overdue

Filter by **Active** / **Completed** / **Defaulted** or by lender. Tap a loan to see its **balance**, **repayment schedule**, **payments**, and to **download a statement**.

7. Make payments

- **Payments** shows your full repayment history across all lenders.
- Where enabled, pay by **M-Pesa** directly from a loan (you'll get an STK push prompt on your phone). Otherwise pay your lender as instructed; they record it and your balance updates.
- Every payment has a **receipt** you can view.

8. Your credit score & dashboard

Your **Dashboard** shows a **credit score** built from your repayment behaviour across **all** your lenders, plus totals: borrowed, repaid, outstanding, and on-time rate. Paying on time improves your score — and a good score helps you borrow from more lenders.

9. Your profile

In **Profile** you can:

- update your email, date of birth, and gender,
- view/replace your **identity documents** (photo + ID),
- **change your password**,
- **download your account statement**.

Your photo, ID, and core details are shared across every lender you link to — so you only enter them once.

10. Notifications

The **bell** icon shows updates: application decisions, counter-offers, payment confirmations, and due-date reminders.

11. Quick troubleshooting

Issue	What to do
"Invalid phone or password"	Use the phone number you registered with; reset via Forgot password
Stuck on "Verify your identity"	Upload all three images (photo + ID front + back) to continue
My approved loan isn't in *My Loans*	Approved loans live in *My Applications* until the lender disburses them
Can't see a lender after linking	Use the Lenders page; linked lenders are marked, and "See all lenders" reopens the directory
A counter-offer is waiting	Open *My Applications* and Accept or Decline it

Need help? Contact your lender directly, or LenderFest support from the site footer.

